

Andy Cohen Back ... After 30 Years

By JACK HAND
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CLEARWATER, Fla. (AP) — It was late afternoon in the Phillies' clubhouse. With the day's work over Eddie Sawyer lit up a long cigar. Andy Cohen, the newest coach, sat on a trunk with a towel over his shoulders talking about John McGraw and the days, 30 years ago, when he played with the New York Giants.

"He was such a disciplinarian," Cohan said. "I wonder if he could have done it today with these kids."

Ken Silvestri, another coach, shook his head. "Not today. Did you know that we had a \$150,000 pepper game going out there today?" (He referred to a game between two bonus babies).

Cohen, back in the majors after a 30-year wait, was not going to be sidetracked. "I liked McGraw," he went on. "Some of them hated his guts. If he chewed you out, it meant he cared. When he left you alone, you could figure you were on your way."

"Tell us how it was when you broke in, Andy," said Sawyer. "I can still remember reading about it in the papers."

"That was 1928, you're talking about," said Cohen. "I really broke in in 1926. Trouble was I had to beat out a guy named Franie Frisch. I didn't. The next year I had to beat out a guy named Rogers Hornsby. Once again, I DIDN'T I wound up in Buffalo.

"When they traded Hornsby to

Boston for Shanty Hogan and Jimmy Welsh, I got my chance. No ball player ever had things go better for him. I couldn't do anything wrong. As luck would have it, we opened in the Polo Grounds against Boston with Hornsby playing for them and me on second base. I got three hits and either scored or drove in all the runs as we won the game. The next day I hit a home run that won the game and the following day I got two hits and turned in a good fielding play. After about six weeks I was hitting .350.

"The next year we were playing a game in Cincinnati and I had a bum leg. I didn't want to tell McGraw about it for fear he'd take me out and I'd never get back. I hit a ball over second base that I thought was an easy hit so I took it easy to first, saving the leg. But Hughie Critz leaped into the air, knocked down the ball and threw me out.

"I didn't know it then but that was the end for me. McGraw made up his mind right then and there that I had football legs and couldn't run. The next year he had Critz and I was in Newark.

"It took me 30 years to get back but it is great to be here, thanks to John Quinn (Phils' general manager) and Sawyer. I came close once. Mr. Rickey (Branch Rickey) interviewed me for the Pittsburgh job when I was managing in Denver but Bobby Bragan got the job. Thirty years. That's a long wait between stops."